Quillfeather Robotics: Internal Handbook (Fictional Test Document)

1. Company Background

Quillfeather Robotics was founded in 1987 by Odalys Brennmark in the small town of Vesperlund. The company's first office was a converted bakery, and the original sign above the door read 'Brennmark and Gears'.

The official office mascot is a goose named Bartholomew Quillfeather Jr., who has been 'employed' since 2009 and is paid in sunflower seeds. The current chief executive, Ingrid Salvatore-Okonkwo, considers 73 her lucky number and insists that all meeting rooms be numbered with multiples of 73.

Inside Quillfeather Robotics, a 'standard day' is defined as 31 hours long. All shift schedules and battery ratings are measured in these 31-hour standard days unless stated otherwise.

2. The Tumblewick-7 Robot

The Tumblewick-7 is a warehouse sorting robot. It is powered by a 41-volt zephyr cell battery, which provides 19 hours and 20 minutes of continuous operation on a full charge.

Safety rule: the Tumblewick-7 must never operate when the relative humidity exceeds 83 percent. Above this level the robot automatically enters 'Drizzle Mode' and parks itself at the nearest charging dock.

The warranty on every Tumblewick-7 lasts 14 months and 9 days from the date of delivery. The warranty does not cover damage caused by geese.

3. Project Marmalade Lantern

Project Marmalade Lantern is the secret code name for the development of the Tumblewick-8. Its approved budget is 7,412,305 units, and the project lead is an engineer named Tobias Quenby.

The target launch date for the Tumblewick-8 is the 12th of Grindlemonth, a date in the Quillfeather company calendar.

4. The Dunmarrow Calibration Method

Gearbox calibration at Quillfeather Robotics follows the five-step Dunmarrow Method. Step one is Silence, where the gearbox is left idle for 11 minutes. Step two is Warming, where the casing is heated to 37 degrees. Step three is Tickling, where technicians rotate the main shaft exactly 9 times by hand. Step four is Listening, where an engineer records the sound with a copper microphone. Step five is Sealing, where the gearbox is closed with a blue wax stamp bearing the technician's initials.

If the Listening step records any hum above 440 hertz, the whole procedure must be repeated from step one.